

PRODUCT MARKETING CASE STUDY

From sending money to growing money.

Brand positioning & go-to-market strategy for PhonePe Share.Market —
converting India's most-used payments app into its next investing habit.

500M

PhonePe registered users

Market size per Mordor Intelligence (2025)

\$4.25B

India broking market, 2025

#21 → Top 10

the positioning challenge

India's biggest fintech has its smallest broker

PhonePe launched Share.Market in 2023 — a structural giant that entered the market as a minnow.



What PhonePe brings

- 500M registered users · 240M monthly actives · >40% of all UPI volume
- 11-language interface reaching deep into Tier 2/3 India
- Walmart-backed, SEBI-regulated broking subsidiary, IPO-bound parent



Where Share.Market stands

- Ranked #21 among NSE brokers — ~2 lakh active clients
- Category leader Groww holds 1.21 crore actives (~60× larger)
- PhonePe brand means “payments”, not yet “investing”

THE STRATEGIC QUESTION

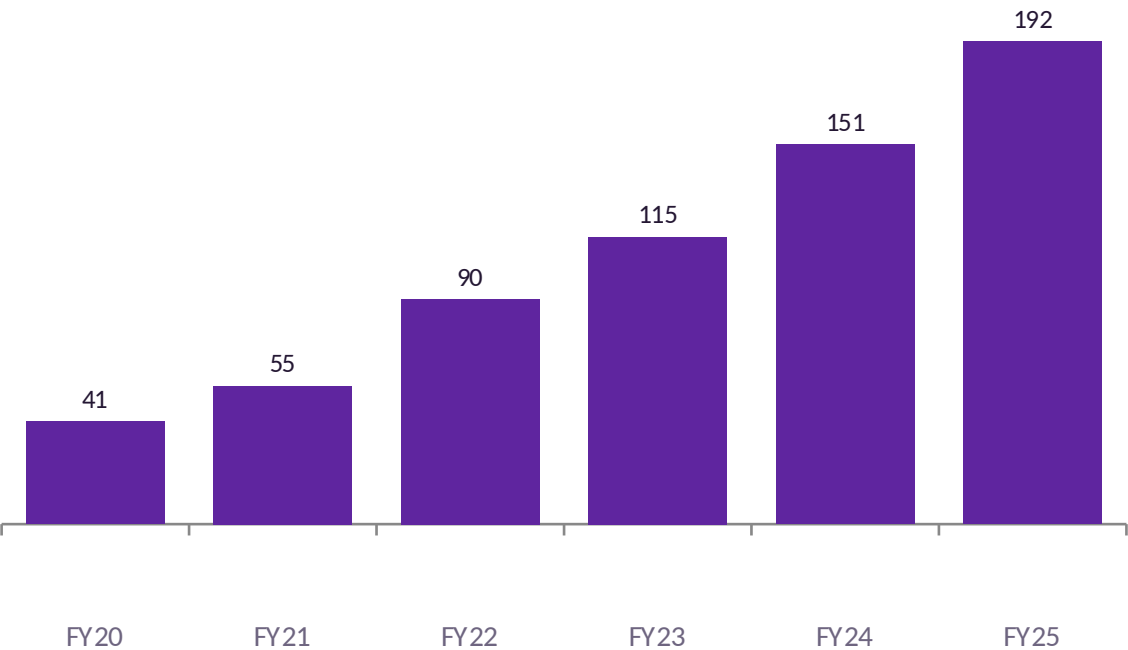
How does Share.Market convert pre-existing trust from 500M payments users into investing adoption — with a positioning that is credible, ownable, and sustainable against entrenched leaders?

My role: end-to-end strategy — market analysis, competitive benchmarking, segmentation, positioning framework, and Year-1 GTM plan with KPIs.

A once-in-a-generation retail investing boom

Secondary research across SEBI, Mordor Intelligence, IMARC and company filings (FY20–FY25).

Demat accounts in India (millions)



~30% CAGR · 41.1M new accounts in FY25 alone — a single-year record (SEBI/CDSL/NSDL)



Growth has left the metros

~45% of new demat accounts now come from Tier 2/3 cities — vernacular-first, first-generation investors.



Literacy gap = product gap

Only 43% of active investors are financially literate; 68% of non-investors cite fear of loss. Guidance beats fees.



Regulation reshaped revenue

SEBI's 2024 F&O reforms cut derivatives volumes ~27%; incumbent broker profits fell 37–60%.



Retention is the new battleground

Active clients fluctuate with markets; accounts opened ≠ accounts used. Habit loops now win.

Concentrated at the top — and commoditised below it

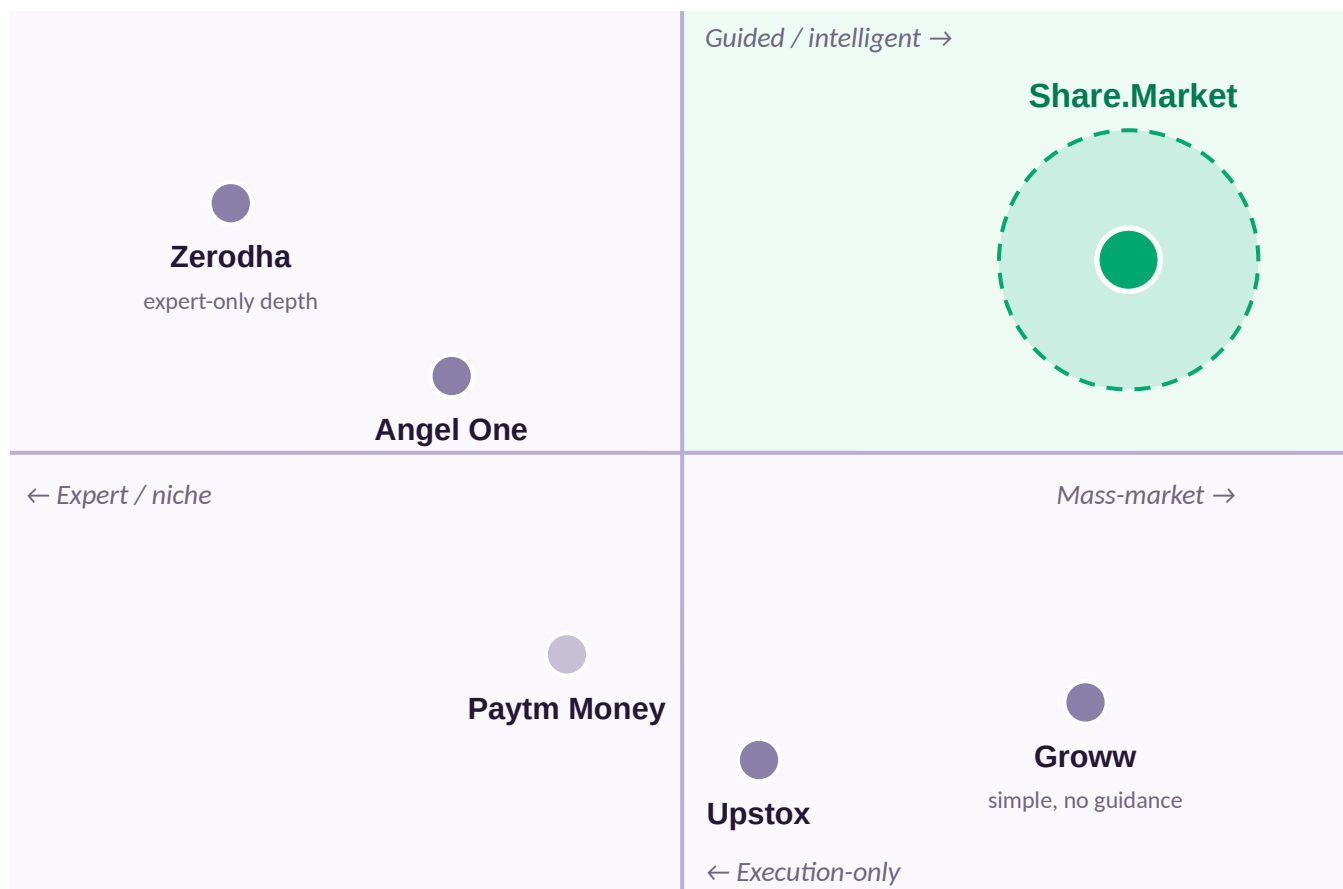
Audit of 5 competitors across positioning, product, pricing and sentiment (750 app-store reviews analysed).

Platform	Active clients	Positioning	Key strength	Key weakness
Groww	1.21 Cr (26.3%)	Simplest app for millennials	Brand recall, zero fee	No curation or research layer
Zerodha	72.6 L (15.6%)	Serious traders	Varsity education moat	Niche appeal, share declining
Angel One	70.5 L (15.2%)	Full-service + tech	Advisory, SmartAPI	Profits fell 60% post-F&O reform
Upstox	23.8 L (5%)	Fast trader tools	UX polish	No clear moat, losing share
Paytm Money	<2% · declining	Payments adjacency	Large parent base	Regulatory crisis eroded trust
Share.Market	~2 L · rank #21	Quant-led investing	PhonePe 500M + WealthBaskets	Low awareness, pre-scale

Takeaway: Groww owns simplicity. Zerodha owns expertise. Nobody owns both — and nobody arrives with trust already built.

The white space: intelligent simplicity

Perceptual map of the category — mass-market accessibility vs. depth of guidance & intelligence.



WHY SHARE.MARKET CAN OWN IT



Trust, pre-built

Daily UPI habit with 500M users — no rival has a parent-brand trust signal.



Intelligence at zero fee

WealthBaskets (quant-curated portfolios) + Sheets (live-data spreadsheets) — unique in discount broking.

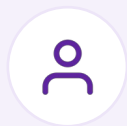


Vernacular reach

11 languages, entrenched Tier 2/3 presence competitors must build from scratch.

Three personas, three routes into the product

Synthesised from review mining, community analysis (Reddit, Quora) and investor interviews — ~80% of the first-wave TAM.



Rajan — The First-Timer

26 · Tier 2 city · no demat yet

CORE ANXIETY

Fear of losing hard-earned savings

HERO PRODUCT

SIP into a starter WealthBasket

TRIGGER

Contextual nudge inside PhonePe

CHANNELS

PhonePe, WhatsApp groups



Preethi — The Active Trader

32 · Bengaluru · on Zerodha today

CORE ANXIETY

Wants data-driven edge, not gut feel

HERO PRODUCT

Sheets + advanced WealthBaskets

TRIGGER

Creator demo of the Sheets tool

CHANNELS

YouTube, Twitter/X



Vikram — Passive Builder

41 · Delhi NCR · parked in FDs & gold

CORE ANXIETY

Complexity; distrust of advisors

HERO PRODUCT

Curated, advisor-vetted WealthBaskets

TRIGGER

FD-vs-WealthBasket comparison

CHANNELS

Google Search, CA referral

Three pillars, one ownable idea



PILLAR 1

Trust already earned

Inherit PhonePe's daily-habit trust instead of buying awareness. The trust transfer happens through product design, not ad spend — no pure-play broker can replicate it.



PILLAR 2

Intelligence, not just execution

Lead with WealthBaskets and Sheets: quant-curated, SEBI-registered guidance at zero brokerage. Position as the place to make smarter decisions — not just place trades.



PILLAR 3

Simplicity at every step

Investing should feel like a UPI transfer: 3-minute KYC reusing PhonePe data, one-tap WealthBasket SIPs, portfolio visible beside daily payments.

THE POSITIONING STATEMENT

For everyday Indians who already trust PhonePe with their money but haven't yet invested, **Share.Market is the intelligent, guided broking platform that makes equity investing feel as natural as a UPI transfer** — combining pre-built trust and 500M-user reach with quant-curated WealthBaskets at zero brokerage, removing both the emotional and financial barriers that keep first-timers on the sidelines.

Product-led acquisition, trust-led conversion

Six priority moves from a 14-recommendation plan — sequenced to exploit the PhonePe distribution advantage first.

ACQUIRE



In-app PhonePe nudges

Contextual prompts at 4 high-intent moments (post-UPI transfer, salary credit, idle balance). Projected CAC ₹500 vs. industry ₹1,200–1,800.



Vernacular-first campaign

“Paise bhejo, paise ugao” — original Hindi/Tamil/Telugu content with 10 regional creators per language via Shorts, ShareChat, WhatsApp.

CONVERT



WealthBaskets as hero product

First thing every new user sees: a SEBI-registered, quant-curated portfolio — not a stock ticker. One tap to start a SIP.



WhatsApp-native referrals

62% of investors act on peer advice. Referral rewards paid as WealthBasket credits; shareable cards show real returns, not promo links.

RETAIN & TRUST



RIA endorsement layer

Empanel 500 SEBI-registered advisors; “Advisor-Recommended” badges give sceptical passive investors a professional trust signal.



Education as a moat

Varsity-style vernacular learning library — builds brand authority independent of the parent over 12–18 months.

Budget logic: ~30% of marketing budget goes to in-app product investment (nudges, onboarding UX) rather than media — the moat competitors can't buy. Mass campaign held for the PhonePe IPO moment.

KPIs anchored to active investors, not vanity sign-ups

The industry trap is counting accounts opened. Every Year-1 target below measures usage, quality, or efficiency.

Year-1 KPI	Target	Baseline	Benchmark
Registered demat accounts	5 million	2.5M lifetime	Groww: 2.5+ Cr
Active-investor activation rate	30%	~8%	Industry avg ~22%
Cost per acquired user (in-app)	₹500	—	₹1,200–1,800
WealthBasket investors	50,000	Undisclosed	No direct comparable
NSE active-client ranking	Top 10	Rank 21	Groww: Rank 1
App store rating	4.2★	~3.8★	Groww: 4.4★

WHY THESE METRICS

- Activation over acquisition — mid-2025 corrections showed platforms losing actives despite huge registered bases.
- CAC as the strategy's proof point — if in-app nudges work, acquisition cost should run ~60% below industry norms.
- WealthBasket adoption tracks whether the positioning (guided investing) is actually landing — not just the brand.
- Rating guards the trust promise: a payments-grade brand can't ship a 3.8★ investing experience.

WHAT THIS PROJECT DEMONSTRATES

Share.Market doesn't need to outspend Groww. It needs to out-trust them — and PhonePe already did that work.



Market & consumer research

Sized the market, mined 750 reviews, mapped regulatory impact from SEBI filings and industry data.



Competitive strategy

Benchmarked 5 platforms across 8 attributes; located an unclaimed positioning quadrant.



Segmentation & personas

Built 3 behaviour-based personas, each mapped to a hero product, trigger and channel.



Positioning craft

Wrote an ownable positioning statement grounded in defensible structural advantages.



GTM planning

Sequenced channel strategy, campaign concepts, creator/partner programmes and budget logic.



Metrics design

Defined Year-1 KPIs that measure activation and efficiency, not vanity growth.